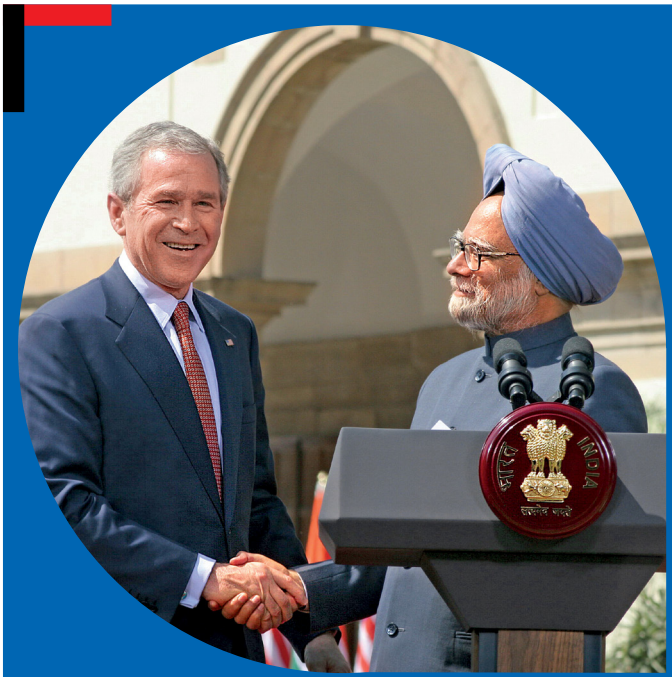
PRASHANT PANJIAR



Reordering Foreign Policy

1992-93

A changed post-Cold War global reality required a larger reordering of foreign policy, which also meant discarding existing shibboleths. Prime Minister **Narasimha Rao**'s decision to establish diplomatic relations with Israel overturned four decades of following the mainstream Arab position on the issue. This was, however, part of a wider cluster of changes that included a changed external economic posture, an uptick in relations with post-revolution Iran, a new emphasis on Southeast Asia and a willingness to engage with the United States.



HEMANT CHAWLA

India-US Civil Nuclear Agreement

2005

The announcement of an India-US Civil Nuclear initiative shattered many taboos. It decisively ended the external perception that India's nuclear status was somehow clandestine and heralded a new closeness in India-US relations and world views. Securing the approval of the Nuclear Suppliers Group to civil nuclear cooperation with India, and convincing Indian political opinion to adjust to the new proximity in India-US relations, brought diplomacy and domestic politics into the same equation—a potential minefield that prime minister **Manmohan Singh** navigated deftly.